



BRITISH SOPWITH PUP

GERMAN ALBATROSS D.Va

WAR IN THE AIR

Powered flight was barely ten years old when war broke out but the technology developed quickly. Soon, both sides were building fast fighter planes and giant bombers capable of carrying huge bombs.



ALTIMETER

FRENCH PILOT'S GOGGLES AND HELMET

WAR AT SEA

World War I was fought mainly on land, with very few major naval battles. The main role of the navies on each side was to protect merchant ships bringing in essential goods, as well as trying to stop the enemy from receiving supplies by sea.



HMS DREADNOUGHT

HMS SCOUT

GERMAN BATTLESHIP

GERMANY'S GREATEST NAVAL WEAPONS WERE ITS SUBMARINES, KNOWN AS U-BOATS

TANK WARFARE

The tank was one of the most important inventions of the war. Although early tanks were unreliable and dangerous for crews working in them, their ability to power through enemy lines meant an end to the stalemate of trench warfare.



BRITISH MARK V TANK

ARMY RECRUITS

Millions of young men were either called up or volunteered to fight in the war. Countries such as Britain also relied heavily on recruits from their overseas colonies and dominions.



FRANCE

GERMANY



OTTOMAN EMPIRE

USA



ITALY

RUSSIA

TRENCH WEAPONS

Trench warfare called for weapons that could be used at very close quarters. Soldiers on raiding missions behind enemy lines carried daggers and knives so they could attack the enemy silently.



AMERICAN BAYONET

AMERICAN KNUCKLEDUSTER KNIFE

GERMAN BAYONET



PERCUSSION AND STICK GRENADES



HAND GRENADES



BRITISH NAIL CLUB

BRITISH SPIKED CLUB

GERMAN ROD

GERMAN CLUB

FIREARMS

The most widely used weapons were rifles and machine-guns. Machine-guns needed only a small crew, were reliable, and had a long range. This made them essential weapons in the trenches.



AUSTRIAN STEYR PISTOL

ITALIAN GLISENTI PISTOL

GERMAN LUGER PISTOL

GERMAN MOUNTED MACHINE-GUN

BRITISH LEE ENFIELD RIFLE

ITALIAN CARCANO CARBINE RIFLE

GERMAN SCHWARZLOSE MACHINE-GUN

BOMBARDMENT

Large field guns fired shells that exploded on impact. They had a long range and could be devastatingly effective but they were not very mobile and needed about ten men to operate them.



GERMAN GAS SHELLS

RUSSIAN MAXIM M1910 HEAVY MACHINE-GUN

BRITISH MORTAR SHELLS

FRENCH 75 MM FIELD GUN

GERMAN 77 MM FIELD GUN